Vox Populi on CachyOS

Civilization V + Vox Populi via Steam and Proton

Revision 11.8.0 | 2026-10-25 | Vox Populi 5.4.8 (stable) | Protontricks 1.14.1-1 | Proton 11.0

CachyOS with native Steam; other distributions in §3

CRITICAL decides whether this works **WARNING** a common failure **Check** verify before going on

No terminal is needed on CachyOS: the work happens in Steam, your package manager (Shelly, or Octopi on systems installed before the April 2026 ISO), the Protontricks and Winetricks windows, the installer's wizard, your file manager and a text editor.

Work through §4–§6 in order: Steps 1–8, then the first launch with VP (§6). Every step that writes to disk ends in a **Check** (Step 7's is Step 8). **WARNING** marks a common failure, **CRITICAL** a step that decides whether this works at all.

Maintained at github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos; `vox-populi-cachyos.pdf` carries the same text.

Contents

BEFORE YOU START
1. How it works 1
2. Requirements 3
3. Other distributions 4

INSTALL
4. Preparing the game 5
5. Installing Vox Populi 5
6. First launch with VP 7

CONFIGURE AND PLAY
7. Settings and stability 8
8. Community Patch options 9
9. Adding other mods 10
10. Multiplayer 11

MAINTAIN
11. Updating 12
12. Uninstalling 12

WHEN SOMETHING FAILS
13. Troubleshooting 13
14. Alternative installer 14
15. Bug reporting 14

ABOUT THIS GUIDE
16. Limits 14

1 How it works

Vox Populi (VP) is the Community Patch Project's overhaul of Civilization V: Brave New World — a replacement game-core DLL with AI and bug fixes (the Community Patch) plus rebalanced rules and new systems.

Proton is mandatory. Vox Populi ships a Windows game-core DLL that the native Aspyr Linux build cannot load.

The installer is Inno Setup 6, a plain Win32 wizard that needs no .NET and renders correctly under Proton.

It cleans up after itself. Before writing, it deletes `cache`, every legacy VP folder and VP's previous files in the Documents and game folders, so clear nothing by hand beforehand — and expect any edit inside a VP mod folder to be lost at the next install or update.

There is no uninstaller entry (`Uninstallable=no`). Removal is the **Uninstall all** setup type in the same `.exe`.

It asks for two different paths; the second one decides the install:

Wizard page	Resolves to	Receives
Select Destination Location — the Documents path **LEAVE AS IS**	`{userdocs}\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5` Under Proton: `C:\users\steamuser\Documents\…` in the prefix	`MODS\(1) Community Patch` `MODS\(2) Vox Populi` `MODS\(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files` `MODS\(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch` `MODS\(4a) Squads for VP` `MODS\(5) Modpack Maker for VP` `Text\VPUI_tips_en_us.xml`
Select the Civilization V folder — custom page, after Setup Type **SET THIS ONE**	Whatever you enter — the **REAL** game install, reached through `S:\` or `Z:\` (Wine maps `Z:` to /)	`Assets\DLC\VPUI` (VP setups) `Assets\DLC\UI_bc1` (EUI setups) `Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Expansion2.Civ5Pkg` (replaced) `Assets\DLC\Expansion2\Sounds\XML\MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml`

The Documents default is already correct: it resolves inside the prefix (the Wine prefix Proton keeps for the game, §2), where the Windows build reads mods. The Civilization V folder page arrives blank on a clean prefix; the wizard pre-fills it only when a game tree already sits inside the prefix under `C:\Program Files (x86)\Steam\…` — the phantom tree.

> **CRITICAL** — Aim that page at the real Linux install and nothing needs copying. The wizard refuses a folder that lacks `Assets\DLC` or any of the ten DLC folders (Step 2), so a wrong path is blocked — except the phantom tree, which passes that test and sends the UI assets where the game never reads them.

The install at a glance

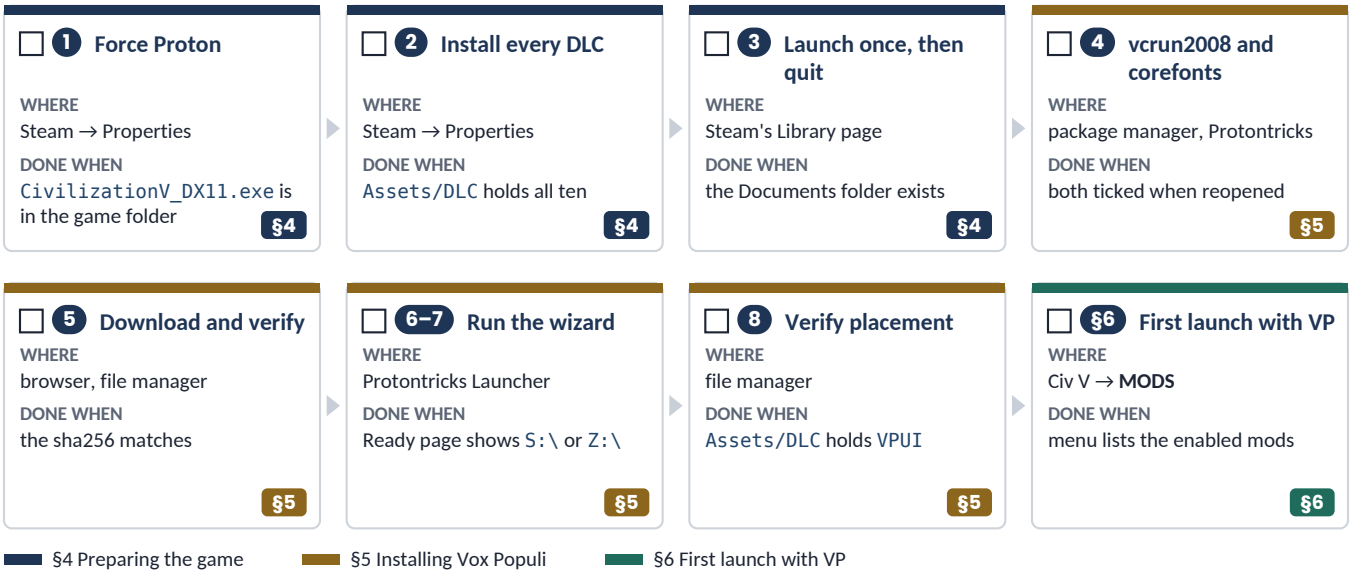


Figure 1 · The install at a glance: tick each box when its check passes.

2 Requirements

Item	Requirement
Game	Civilization V 1.0.3.279, all expansions and all DLC installed
Steam	Native Steam, the multilib `steam` package; other packagings: §3
Compat tool	Proton Experimental or newest numbered Proton (11.0 at this revision); `proton-cachyos-slr` OK. **NOT** a "Steam Linux Runtime" entry (Step 1)
Language	Game language English (Steam → Properties → Language). VP ships its text in English only; other languages show missing or stale entries
Tooling	`extra/protontricks` 1.14.1-1 with `yad` (game list) and `zenity` (Winetricks dialogs; a `steam` dependency); pulls `winetricks`, `wine` and `cabextract`
Disk	Full re-download of the Windows depots (the Steam store asks for 8 GB free) plus the 110 MB installer
Conflicts	Remove every mod VP blocks (§9), Workshop copies included; no other mod may ship its own DLL

The procedure works in the four folders below. Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Installed Files** → **Browse** opens the game folder; the library is the folder above `steamapps`, and the prefix always sits in the same library as the game. Show hidden files in your file manager — `.local` and `.steam` are hidden.

Folder	Location and contents
Steam library	`~/.local/share/Steam` (also `~/.steam/root`), native Steam's default on CachyOS. A game in a secondary library uses that library; other packagings: §3
Game folder	`<library>/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V`
In the wizard	`S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V`, or its `Z:\` form (Step 7)
Prefix	`<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930/pfx`, created in Step 3
Documents folder	`<prefix>/drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/My Games/Sid Meier's Civilization 5`, where the Windows build keeps:
Mods	`MODS`: the numbered VP folders and any added mod (§6, §9)
Caches	`cache` · `ModUserData`: delete after any mod change (§9)
Saves	`Saves`; multiplayer autosaves in `Saves/multi/auto` (§10)
Logs and settings	Logs (§15) · `config.ini` and the other `.ini` files (§7)



Figure 2 · The four folders, the drive letters Wine maps onto them and the wizard page that writes into each; nothing may land in the phantom tree.

Bookmark the Documents folder in your file manager; later sections keep sending you back to it.

3 Other distributions

Only three things differ: how Steam is installed, where its default library sits and whether the packaged Protontricks is new enough; from Step 1 on, the procedure is the same. **Protontricks 1.12.0 is the floor**: older releases cannot read the current Steam client's `appinfo.vdf` and stop with "Invalid file magic number".

Distribution	Steam	Protontricks
CachyOS, Arch	`steam` (multilib)	extra, 1.14.1 — Step 4
Ubuntu 26.04 LTS	`steam-installer` (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.13.1 — use it
Ubuntu 24.04 LTS	`steam-installer` (multiverse)	multiverse, 1.10.5 — too old; use the Flatpak
Debian 13	`steam-installer` (contrib)	none in trixie; use the Flatpak
Fedora 44	`steam` (RPM Fusion Nonfree)	fedora, 1.14.0 — use it
Steam Deck	preinstalled	Flatpak, from Discover

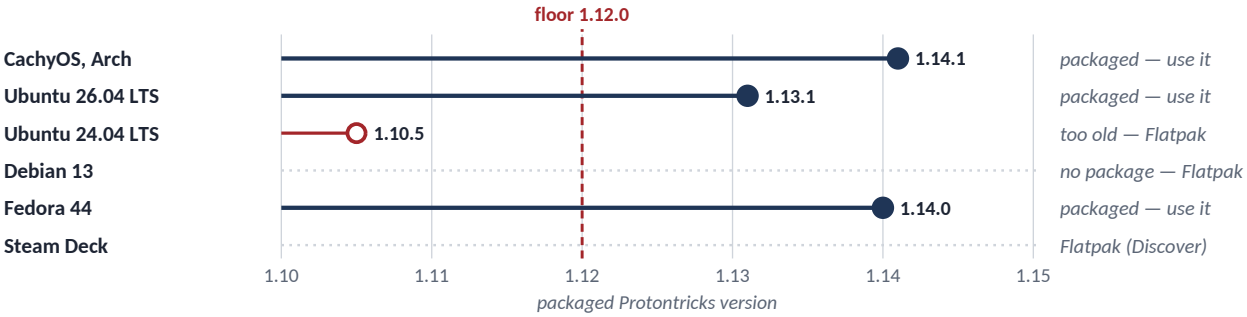


Figure 3 · Protontricks as each distribution packages it, against the 1.12.0 floor: below it or without a package, use the Flatpak.

Where each packaging puts the default Steam library — the §2 library, unless Civ V lives in a secondary one:

Steam packaging	Default library
Native package, any distro	what `~/.steam/root` links to
CachyOS, Arch	`~/.local/share/Steam`
Debian, Ubuntu	`~/.steam/debian-installation` for a new install; older installs may sit in `~/.local/share/Steam`
Flatpak Steam	`~/.var/app/com.valvesoftware.Steam/.local/share/Steam`
Snap Steam	`~/snap/steam/common/.local/share/Steam`

Debian and Ubuntu offer `steam-installer` only with the i386 architecture enabled and the `multiverse` (Ubuntu) or `contrib` (Debian) component on. Debian also wants the 32-bit Mesa packages listed on the Debian wiki's Steam page (wiki.debian.org/Steam), or `nvidia-driver-libs:i386` with NVIDIA's proprietary driver. These preparations and adding Flatpak (flathub.org/setup) use a terminal; from Step 1 on, nothing does.

Where the table says **Flatpak**, add Flathub, install `com.github.Matoking.protontricks` and restart the computer; on the **Steam Deck**, use Desktop Mode's Discover — SteamOS's root is read-only. The Flatpak reaches Steam's directories and the standard home folders and ships the same shortcut and Launcher entries; for a library or installer elsewhere it lists the folders it cannot reach — move the installer into your home folder, or grant access to those folders with Flatseal (from Flathub) rather than with the command the message shows.

Then, on any of them: start Steam once and sign in so it creates its directories, confirm in your package manager that Protontricks is 1.12.0 or newer, then continue with Step 1.

4 Preparing the game

Step 1 · Force Proton

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **Compatibility** → tick **Force the use of a specific Steam Play compatibility tool** → **Proton Experimental** or the newest numbered Proton. Steam swaps the native build for the Windows depots; let it finish. If the download stops with a disk write error, see §13.

> ⚠ **WARNING** — The same dropdown lists Steam Linux Runtime entries. They are not Proton: no Wine prefix is created, and Protontricks stops with "Proton installation could not be found!".

`proton-cachyos-slr` from the CachyOS repositories also works (install it, then restart Steam); despite its name, it is Proton.

Proton 11.0, Experimental and the 11.0-based `proton-cachyos-slr` map `S:` to the game's Steam library, used in Step 7; on Proton 10.0 or older add `PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 %command%` under **Properties** → **General** → **Launch Options**. If the library root is not writable or sits on a different filesystem from `steamapps`, `S:` is `steamapps` itself — type `S:\common\…` in Step 7.

> ✅ **Check:** the game folder (§2) holds `CivilizationV_DX11.exe` among other `.exe` files. No `.exe` at all, and a `Civ5XP` binary instead, means Steam is still serving the native build.

Step 2 · Install every DLC

Steam → right-click **Sid Meier's Civilization V** → **Properties** → **DLC** → tick every entry: owning a DLC is not enough.

> ✅ **Check:** `Assets/DLC` in the game folder holds all ten — `DLC_01`–`DLC_07`, `DLC_Deluxe` (Babylon), `Expansion` (Gods & Kings) and `Expansion2` (Brave New World). A missing one stops the installer at Step 7.

Step 3 · Launch once, then quit

Press **Play** on Steam's Library page and pick **Play Sid Meier's Civilization V (DirectX 10/11)** in the dialog Steam shows. The first start takes longer while Proton builds the prefix; wait for the main menu, then quit. This creates the prefix, which Protontricks needs, and Civ V's Documents folder inside it.

> ✅ **Check:** the Documents folder exists and holds `config.ini`.

5 Installing Vox Populi

Step 4 · Install Protontricks, vcrun2008 and corefonts

Install `protontricks` and `yad` from the CachyOS repositories; `zenity` is already there as a `steam` dependency (other distributions: §3). Then:

1. Open **Protontricks** from the application menu and pick **Sid Meier's Civilization V** — it is listed only after Step 3.
2. In the Winetricks window that opens, choose **Select the default wineprefix** → **OK**; close the 64-bit WINEPREFIX warning if it appears — every Proton prefix is 64-bit.
3. **Install a Windows DLL or component** → **OK** → tick `vcrun2008` → **OK**.
4. **Install a font** → **OK** → tick `corefonts` → **OK**, then close Winetricks.

Both installs download; repeating the step is harmless.

`vcrun2008` is the Visual C++ 2008 runtime the VP game-core DLL imports and `corefonts` the Microsoft core fonts; Wine's built-in replacements usually suffice, and both installs come from a report in thread 702075 (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/702075).

> ✅ **Check:** opened again, those two lists show `vcrun2008` and `corefonts` already ticked.

Step 5 · Download and verify

Open github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/releases and download `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe` from the newest stable release's assets; the asset list shows each file's digest. Skip `Release_Debug.zip` beside it: game-core DLL builds with symbols, for crash analysis only. For 5.4.8:

`Vox.Populi.5.4.8.exe` — 110,434,971 bytes
sha256 `af311eaf212e6c37f27d20b16e9d3fdc9f1ce73b3e7717bee1906635fbce183a`

> ✅ **Check:** the digest your file manager computes matches (Dolphin: **Properties** → **Checksums**). On a mismatch, delete the file and download it again.

Step 6 · Run the installer inside the prefix

Right-click `Vox.Populi.5.4.8.exe` → **Open With** → **Protontricks Launcher** → **Sid Meier's Civilization V**. The wizard can take a minute to appear and may open behind other windows under Wayland.

Step 7 · Complete the wizard

The actions in capitals decide the result:

Wizard page	Action
License · Information	Accept the agreement, then Next on both
Select Destination Location	**LEAVE AS IS**. It must read `C:\users\steamuser\Documents\My Games\Sid Meier's Civilization 5`
Setup Type / Components	**CHOOSE** one setup type — table below
Select the Civilization V folder	**TYPE** `S:\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V`, or the `Z:\` form of the game folder given below
Ready to Install	**CHECK** that "Civilization V path" shows the `S:\` or `Z:\` path, not `C:\Program Files (x86)\…`
Installing · Finished	Wait, then Finish

The setup types, in the installer's order:

Setup type	What it installs
Vox Populi (with EUI)	Full VP + Enhanced User Interface — the usual choice
Vox Populi (no EUI)	Full VP, stock interface
Community Patch only	AI and bug-fix base mod. **NOT** compatible with EUI
43 Civ Community Patch only, 43 Civ Vox Populi (no EUI), 43 Civ Vox Populi (with EUI)	The same three with a DLL supporting 43 major civs
Uninstall all	Removal — §12

The `Z:\` form for CachyOS's default library; with another library, replace the part before `steamapps` with its path:

```
Z:\home\<your user name>\.local\share\Steam\steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V
```

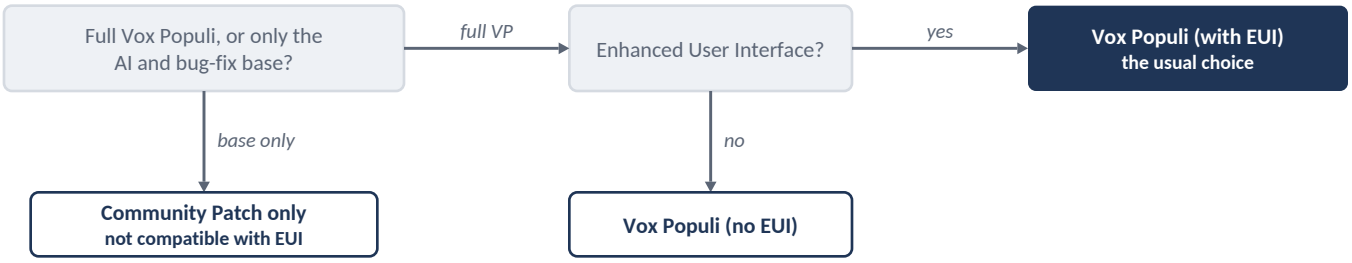


Figure 4 · Choosing the setup type; for 43 major civs take the 43 Civ version of the same type.

Step 8 · Verify placement

> ✅ **Check:** `Assets/DLC` in the game folder now holds `VPUI`, plus `UI_bc1` with EUI — the pass/fail test for Step 7. **Community Patch only** installs neither but still adds `Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml` there. The Documents folder's `MODS` holds the numbered mod folders of your setup type.

If the Check fails and `<prefix>/drive_c/Program Files (x86)/Steam/steamapps/common/Sid Meier's Civilization V` exists, the files went into that phantom tree: re-run the installer with the real path.

6 First launch with VP

1. Launch Civ V from Steam's Library page, as in Step 3.
2. Main menu → **MODS**; accept the prompt if one appears.
3. The first entry into the MODS menu runs a "configuring game data" pass of 5–15 minutes — not a hang; if it crashes, relaunch (§13).
4. Enable the VP mods as the table below says.
5. Press **NEXT**, never **Back**.
6. **Single Player** → **Set Up Game**. In this menu, **Single Player** looks like a heading but is a button.

Mod	When to enable it
(1) Community Patch	Always — every other VP mod requires it
(2) Vox Populi	Always for VP setups — requires (1)
(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files	**MUST** be on for any EUI install
(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch	Only for 43-civ variants
(4a) Squads for VP	Optional: RTS-style control groups (quality of life)
(5) Modpack Maker for VP	Leave off for normal play; builds modpacks (§10)

> ❗ **CRITICAL** — **Back** returns to the main menu and silently deactivates the mod set: the most common "I installed VP and nothing changed" report.

> ✅ **Check:** after **NEXT** the menu lists the enabled mods; missing VP units or wrong text: §13.

7 Settings and stability

Autosaves

In **Options**, set **Turns Between Autosaves** to 1 and **Max Autosaves** to 0 (unlimited), as VP's bug form recommends; for multiplayer, set **Max Autosaves** to 500, as the modpack thread asks. The aim is a save from the turn *before* a problem (§15).

Crashes

Most late-game crashes are a memory problem, not a Vox Populi bug. The project blames exhaustion of the 32-bit address space: 4 GB under Proton, whose `PROTON_FORCE_LARGE_ADDRESS_AWARE` is **on by default** (leave it), whatever RAM is installed. VP's **Game Crash** message names the case — the crash "happened with the 32-bit address space nearly exhausted"; without that line, look elsewhere and report it (§15). Mitigations, most important first:

1. **Leader Scene Quality** on **Minimum**.
2. Yield icons off from the Industrial era (in multiplayer, by every player), or avoid zooming far out.
3. Standard or small maps.
4. A lower in-game resolution — ultrawide and 4K panels are the demanding case.
5. **Strategic View** in the late game.
6. No memory-heavy mods such as InfoAddict.
7. **Single Unit Graphics** from Unit Scaling and Formation for VP (§9), set up as its opening post explains.
8. With EUI, the **Vox Populi (no EUI)** setup type: re-run the installer (Steps 6–8); saves stay compatible.

Early, random crashes are a different problem. ProtonDB reports tie them to the thread count; the reported fix is the launch option `taskset -c 0-7 %command%` (**Properties** → **General** → **Launch Options**; with Step 1's option, `PROTON_SET_GAME_DRIVE=1 taskset -c 0-7 %command%`), which pins the game to eight threads. Raising `MaxSimultaneousThreads` in the Documents folder's `config.ini` (default 8) to the machine's thread count helped one reporter, but 24 stopped the game from starting for another — set it back to 8 if the game no longer starts.

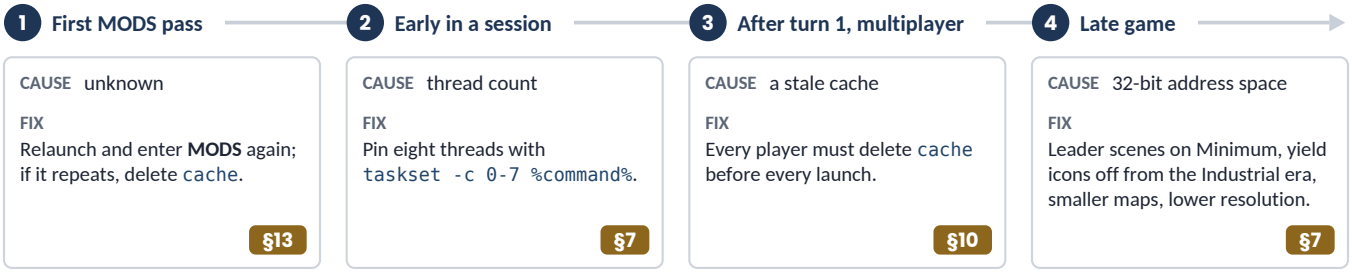


Figure 5 · Crash triage by when the crash happens.

Performance and configuration files

Late-game turn times are AI-bound, not GPU-bound: treat graphics settings as a memory lever and cap the frame rate at the panel's refresh rate with VSync. **Quick Combat** and **Quick Movement** (**Options** → **Game**) save wall-clock time.

The settings are plain-text `.ini` files in the Documents folder (copies under `~/.local/share/Aspyr` serve only the native build). Edit them with the game closed; the menus write the same files, and a deleted file returns to defaults.

File	What it holds
`config.ini`	Debugging, logging (§15), audio switches and startup parameters — `MaxSimultaneousThreads` (above) lives here
`UserSettings.ini`	User options — `SkipIntroVideo`, `NoBasicHelp`, `DisableAdvisorSpeech` and `AutoWorkersDontReplace` among them

File	What it holds
`GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini`	Everything from Options → Video for the DX11 build: resolution, fullscreen, VSync, MSAA, the detail levels
`GraphicsSettingsDX9.ini`	The same for the DX9 build — each build keeps its own

The next table pairs each **Options → Video** setting with its `GraphicsSettingsDX11.ini` key and a performance-first value; forum benchmarks single out anti-aliasing and terrain tessellation:

Options → Video	Key	Performance-first
Anti-Aliasing	`MSAASamples`	Off (1). Costliest item; DX11 AA can also black out the screen
VSync	`WaitForVSync`	On (1). Caps at the refresh rate, steadies frame times
Leader Scene Quality	—	Minimum — saves memory
Terrain Tessellation Level	`TerrainTessLevel`, `BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv`	Low. On a weak GPU also set `BicubicTerrainTessSubdiv` 0
Shadow Detail · Terrain Shadow Quality	`ShadowLevel`, `TerrainShadowQuality`	Low
Water Quality · reflections	`TerrainWaterQuality`, `ReflectionLevel`	Low · off
High Detail Strategic View	`HDStrategicView`	Off (0)
Overlay Detail · Fog of War · Terrain Detail Level	`OverlayLevel`, `FOWLevel`, `TerrainDetailLevel`	Low
Texture Quality	`TextureQuality`	High, unless late-game crashes point at memory

Two fixes exist only in the graphics file: `MinimizeGrayTiles = 1` stops the gray tiles that appear while scrolling on weaker GPUs (the official Steam FAQ's fix), and `FullScreen`, `WindowResX` and `WindowResY` in its `[UserSettings]` section recover a game that opens at a size the screen cannot show — the DX11 build needs at least 768 pixels of height.

8 Community Patch options

The options file is `MODS/(1) Community Patch/Database Changes/NewCustomModOptions.xml` in the Documents folder. Its header sets three rules:

- An option with a **"See also:"** comment is enabled through its mod, not here.
- An option listing **"Defines:"** or **"PostDefines:"** needs those defines checked first.
- Anything else is enabled by changing `Value` from `0` to `1`.

A row's `Class` (0 Data … 6 Major) describes what kind of option it is, not how safe it is. Leave Class 3, Events, alone unless you need it: those options run game-core triggers whether or not anything consumes them. Four options worth knowing:

Option	Effect
`ENABLE_ACHIEVEMENTS`	Steam achievements in modded single player. Marked "**FUNCTIONALITY NOT GUARANTEED**"; it changes the save format, so set it before a campaign, not during
`DIPLO_DEBUG_MODE` (+ `…_SETTING`)	Reveals the AI's true opinion, approach and Congress voting; at setting 2 the AI accepts every Discuss request
`SQLITE_LOGGING`	Writes gameplay statistics to a queryable `stats.db`
`CORE_DEBUGGING`	Extra game-core debugging; slows the game, leave off

Delete `cache` after editing, and note your changes: each update rewrites the file, so re-apply them.

9 Adding other mods

Rules for every added mod

- Any mod that ships its own DLL is incompatible: VP replaces the game-core DLL.
- VP reworks most systems: anything beyond maps, civilizations, art or interface needs a version made for VP.
- Download from CivFanatics or GitHub, not the Steam Workshop: under Proton its subscriptions do not reliably land in the right place.
- Mods go in the Documents folder's `MODS`, beside the VP folders.
- After **ANY** mod change, delete `cache` and `ModUserData` in the Documents folder; a stale `cache` is the usual reason mods look broken.
- Lowercasing filenames is a native-build fix; Proton does not need it.

Remove what VP blocks. VP's modinfo files block the add-ons it absorbs or replaces: More Luxuries, City-State Diplomacy (CSD), Civ IV Diplomatic Features, More Unique Components, Promotion Icons, Enhanced Naval Warfare, standalone Squads for VP, Bridges and Canals, Artificial Unintelligence, Archaeology Aesthetic Adjustments and several UI mods; (4a) also blocks Linked and Group Unit Movement, and (5) blocks Multiplayer Mods Workaround. A blocked mod cannot be enabled beside the mod that blocks it; delete it, Workshop copies included.

Where compatible mods live

Mods for VP are posted in the Community Patch Project's **Mods Repository** (forums.civfanatics.com/forums/549) subforum. Its sticky *Mod Compatibility with Latest Version* (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/701787) says every mod there is meant to work with the current VP; mods that stop working move to the **Mods Archive**. A thread's opening post (OP) holds the download and its last pages hold the reports for the current version. Copies in the **Downloads** section and on the Steam Workshop can lag by years.

Popular mods for VP

Eight of the most popular mods made for VP, by CivFanatics downloads, thread views and players' shared mod lists; every thread shows 2026 activity:

Mod and author	What it adds	Version and notes
More Wonders for VP by adan_eslavo	New world and natural wonders	v24.11, VP 5.3.3+; an effects folder goes in the game folder
Even More Resources for Vox Populi by HungryForFood	New bonus, luxury and city-state resources	v8; OP links updates, incl. one for Unique City-States
Unique City-States by adan_eslavo	Unique traits for city-states	v19.3, VP 5.4.x
City-States Leaders for VP by adan_eslavo	Leaders for city-states	v26, VP 5.3.x; made for Unique City-States
Community Patch Events by Enginseer	200+ new events	OP links updated build
Wonder Planner for VP by adan_eslavo	Planning screen for wonders	v20
Better Lakes for VP by InkAxis	Lake rework	OP links updated build
Unit Scaling and Formation for VP by N.Core	Unit model size and formations	v12

Versions are as the authors state them; rows without one have none stated.

Installing a mod

1. Download from the opening post, not the Steam Workshop (see the rules above).
2. Extract the archive. A `.civ5mod` is a 7-Zip archive under another name; rename it to `.7z` if your archiver refuses it, and extract it yourself rather than leaving it in `MODS`.
3. Move the folder that contains the `.modinfo` file straight into the Documents folder's `MODS`, beside the numbered VP folders — not the archive, not a folder inside a folder.
4. If the opening post names a Windows path under `steamapps\common\Sid Meier's Civilization V`, use the real game folder (§2), never the phantom `C:\Program Files (x86)` tree inside the prefix (Step 8).
5. Delete `cache` and `ModUserData` in the Documents folder.
6. In the MODS menu, enable the VP set first, then the new mod, then press **NEXT**. The mod lists what it requires: nearly all need (1) and (2).

Add one mod at a time and play a few turns before the next, so a crash points at the last one added (§13). For multiplayer the mod must be part of the modpack (§10); a mod enabled through the menu cannot join a modpack game.

10 Multiplayer

VP cannot be played in multiplayer through the MODS menu; it must be packaged as a modpack, which loads like a DLC.

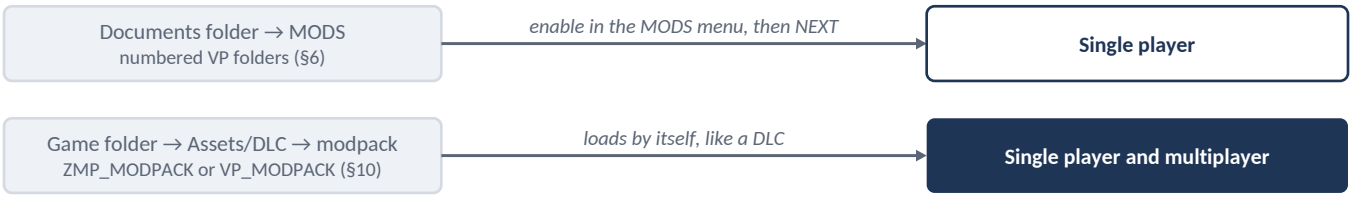


Figure 6 · Where the game loads VP from: the MODS menu serves single player only; a modpack in Assets/DLC loads like a DLC and serves both.

Preferred — a prebuilt modpack. The CivFanatics modpack thread 685164 (forums.civfanatics.com/threads/685164) tracks current releases (5.4.8), including one generated on Linux under Proton. Extract so its folders — `ZMP_MODPACK` and any `VPUI` or `UI_bc1` it carries — sit directly under the game folder's `Assets/DLC`, then delete the Documents folder's `cache`.

Alternative — build your own with the Modpack Maker:

1. Turn logging on (§15), then enable **(5) Modpack Maker for VP** plus every mod to include.
2. Start or load a game and press **Ctrl+Shift+M**; wait for the "Modpack generation complete" message.
3. Check `Logs/Lua.log` in the Documents folder for errors, and `ModpackMaker.log` beside it; the pack is the game folder's `Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK`.
4. Exit and delete `cache`.
5. Relaunch and start from **Single Player** or **Multiplayer**, never the **MODS** menu.

Alternative — civ5vp-installer. It builds modpacks too (§14).

Modpack rules

- Modpacks cannot be combined with mods activated through the **MODS** menu.
- Every player must use byte-identical modpacks.
- Every player must delete `cache` **BEFORE EVERY LAUNCH**, or the game likely crashes after turn 1.
- Do not hand-edit a modpack folder — rebuild or re-download it instead.
- Saves do not record which modpack was used; a mismatch crashes.
- Multiplayer autosaves live in `Saves/multi/auto` — collect them for desync reports.

To remove a modpack, delete its folders under `Assets/DLC` (`VP_MODPACK` if you built it; `ZMP_MODPACK`, `VPUI` and `UI_bc1` for the thread's packs, per its opening post) and the Documents folder's `cache`. If you also play VP from the MODS menu, re-run the VP installer afterward to restore `VPUI` and `UI_bc1`.

Known issues. Community-Patch-DLL #13349 (github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/issues/13349) reports a 5.4.4 multiplayer desync that its reporter suspects is pathfinding-related; check its state before a long game.

11 Updating

Back up first: copy the Documents folder's `Saves` and `MODS` out of the prefix. A prefix reset destroys the saves, and the installer replaces VP's own mod folders, losing any edit inside them — §8's options file included.

Then download the newer `Vox.Populi.<version>.exe`, check it against its own digest on the release page (Step 5) and run it exactly as in Steps 6–8. No manual cleanup is needed (§1).

By the project's versioning rule, saves are compatible when only the third version component changes: 5.4.6 → 5.4.8 keeps them, 5.4.x → 5.5.0 does not.

> ⚠ **WARNING** — Steam's **Verify integrity of game files** (**Properties** → **Installed Files**) restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`, which VP replaces to fix city-state audio. Re-run the VP installer after any verification.

12 Uninstalling

Preferred — Uninstall all. Re-run the installer as in Step 6, choose **Uninstall all** and point the Civilization V folder page at the same real install; this also restores the stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`.

Fallback — manual removal. Delete these, then run **Verify integrity of game files** (§11) to restore `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg`:

Folder	Delete

Documents folder	`MODS/(1) Community Patch` · `MODS/(2) Vox Populi`
	`MODS/(3a) VP - EUI Compatibility Files`
	`MODS/(3b) 43 Civs Community Patch` · `MODS/(4a) Squads for VP`
	`MODS/(5) Modpack Maker for VP`
	`cache` · `ModUserData` · `Text/VPUI_tips_en_us.xml`

Game folder	`Assets/DLC/VPUI` · `Assets/DLC/UI_bc1`
	`Assets/DLC/VP_MODPACK` · `Assets/DLC/ZMP_MODPACK` (modpacks, §10)
	`Assets/DLC/Expansion2/Sounds/XML/MinorCivSounds_VoxPopuli.xml`

Last resort — prefix reset. Delete `<library>/steamapps/compatdata/8930`; this destroys the saves inside the prefix, so back them up first (§11). The game folder lies outside the prefix, so remove its entries in the table above as well.

What each operation touches:

Operation	Game folder Assets/DLC	MODS	cache	Saves
Install or update (Step 7, §11)	`VPUI`, `UI_bc1` written; `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg` replaced	VP folders rewritten	Deleted	Kept
Steam: Verify integrity (§11)	Stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg` restored; `VPUI`, `UI_bc1` kept	Kept	Kept	Kept
Uninstall all (§12)	VP files removed; stock `Expansion2.Civ5Pkg` restored	VP folders removed	Deleted	Kept
Prefix reset (§12)	Kept: the game folder is outside the prefix	Gone	Gone	Gone

13 Troubleshooting

Setup and install

Symptom	Cause and fix
Steam: "disk write error" during the Windows download (Step 1)	Mixed-case path bug, fixed in the 2026-07-27 Steam client update: update Steam and retry.
"Invalid file magic number"	Protontricks older than 1.12.0. Upgrade, or use the Flatpak (§3).
Flatpak: "does not appear to have access to the following directories"	The file or library is outside the Flatpak's folders (§3): move it, or grant access with Flatseal.
Protontricks does not list Civ V	Prefix absent. Launch once via Proton (Step 3).
"Proton installation could not be found!"	A Steam Linux Runtime entry is selected, not Proton. Pick Proton (Step 1).
"command `cabextract` ... returned status 1"	`cabextract` trips over a symlink Proton created. Delete the symlink the error names; redo Step 4.
Wizard never appears	Check other windows (Wayland focus), then switch the Proton version (Step 1).
"did not provide the correct path"	The folder has no `Assets\DLC` child. Point at the game root, not Assets or DLC. If `S:\` fails, try `S:\common\...` (Step 1) or the `Z:\` form (Step 7).
"You don't have all required DLCs"	The message names the missing packs. Install them (Step 2).

In the game

Symptom	Cause and fix
Crash during the first "configuring game data" pass	Relaunch and enter **MODS** again (§6); if it repeats, delete `cache`.
VP absent from the in-game mod list	Select Destination Location was changed: the mods went elsewhere. Re-run with the default path.
Missing textures, broken UI	The Civilization V folder page pointed at the phantom tree (Step 8). Re-run with the real path.
EUI works, no other VP features	Back was pressed in **MODS**, or (3a) is off on an EUI install. Enable the §6 set, then press **NEXT**.
Tech or policy tree unchanged, or entries show wrong text	Game language is not English. Steam → Properties → Language → English, then delete `cache` (§2).
Mods stale, duplicated or missing	Delete `cache` and `ModUserData` (§9); look for Workshop copies sharing mod IDs, or a mod with its own DLL.
Community Patch option change has no effect	Cache not cleared, or the option needed its defines (§8).
Random crashes early in a session	Thread count: try the `taskset` launch option first; `MaxSimultaneousThreads` is riskier (§7).
Multiplayer crashes after turn 1	A player did not delete `cache` before launch (§10).
Crash to desktop in the late game	The 32-bit address space ran out. Apply §7's crash mitigations in order; keep `crashlogs` (§15).
Still broken after all of the above	Minimal install — VP without EUI, no other mods — then add one layer at a time.

14 Alternative installer

github.com/Alpakinator/civ5vp-installer is a single-file native Linux binary that installs VP without Protontricks — a fallback if the Inno wizard misbehaves, newer and less tested than the Protontricks route. It finds the Civ V folders itself and has a modpack mode; its **Uninstall** button restores an unmodded game.

civ5vp-installer-linux-x86_64 (v0.1.8, 2026-10-22) — 49,392,208 bytes
sha256 d7beb4239096d4344f8ef6b37d7de2c4afae26bf036b6d3747ec610a153a8309

Verify the digest as in Step 5, mark the file executable (Dolphin: **Properties** → **Permissions** → **Is executable**) and open it.

> ⚠ **WARNING** — Install only released VP versions with it. On 2026-08-26 the author advised against its **Compile the DLL myself** option, even for single player: its compiler can produce a DLL that freezes the game.

15 Bug reporting

Vox Populi bugs go to the project's tracker, github.com/LoneGazebo/Community-Patch-DLL/issues, not the forum; errors in this guide go to github.com/ryanmusante/vox-populi-cachyos/issues. The bug form requires the mod version, the installed components (your Step 7 setup type) and a description; it asks for three attachments:

Attachment	Where it is
Save from one turn before the problem	`Saves` in the Documents folder — the reason for the autosave settings in §7
Logs	`Logs` in the Documents folder, zipped — useless unless logging was already on
Crash artifacts, when reporting a crash	`crashlogs` in the game folder (`crashes.log`, `.dmp`) per the bug form; the project's minidump guide says `CvMiniDump_*.dmp` beside the game executable — check both

Logging is off by default and must be on *before* the problem occurs: in the Documents folder's `config.ini`, set `ValidateGameDatabase`, `LoggingEnabled`, `MessageLog`, `AILog`, `AIPerfLog`, `BuilderAILog` and `PlayerAndCityAILogSplit` to `1`. After the problem, copy the logs out *before* loading any game — most are erased on load — and turn logging off afterward.

Dumps are not guaranteed under Proton; if none appears after a crash, say so in the report and attach the logs and save.

16 Limits

- **Written against 5.4.8**; the sha256 is for 5.4.8 only.
- **Read from source, not exercised:** the `S:` drive default, the Protontricks and Winetricks window routes, the §8 toggles and the wording of VP's **Game Crash** message (§7).
- **Community reports, not upstream statements:** the English-language requirement, the vcrun2008 and corefonts step (Step 4), the ProtonDB fixes (§7, §13) and the 2010–2013 Windows benchmarks behind §7's performance values.
- **The mod list is a 2026-10-21 snapshot**; none was tested under Proton, and a mod's last forum page is the authority for the current VP.
- **Untested:** the §3 distributions other than CachyOS (checked against package listings only), Flatpak and Snap Steam, file managers other than KDE's Dolphin, the 43-civ variants and civ5vp-installer's **Compile the DLL myself** option.